

A JOINT EFFORT
Team India celebrate the T20 World Cup win, Ahmedabad, Mar. 8

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MOHAMMED SIRAJ

The fiery pacer had packed his bags to see Real Madrid play in Spain until he got a call from SKY to fill in for the injured Harshit Rana. In his only match—a high-pressure opener vs. USA—he also filled in for Bumrah with three wickets.

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RINKU SINGH

Confronted with tragedy mid-tournament after losing his father to cancer, he rejoined the camp a day after the funeral. Though his place in the XI was gone, he contributed whenever called upon as a substitute fielder.

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KULDEEP YADAV

The left-arm wrist spinner got just one match to showcase his skills—against Pakistan—and had to spend the rest of the tournament watching from the boundary. But as Siraj, who too got a single game, noted after the final: "No person is important; only the team is important."

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TILAK VARMA

Fresh off an injury, the hero of the 2025 Asia Cup final featured in all nine matches of the World Cup, proving a vital force in the middle overs with short, effective knocks. He finished with 207 runs at an average of 29.57.